

Subject: Fwd: Unofficial Arlington Town Meeting Slack
From: Joe Kerble <brotherslawn@hotmail.com>
Date: 5/27/22, 21:21
To: Stephen Harrington <sth.alist@gmail.com>

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Daniel Jalkut <daniel@jalkut.com>
Date: May 27, 2022 at 9:19:33 PM EDT
To: Daniel Jalkut <daniel@jalkut.com>
Cc: Greg Christiana <GChristiana@town.arlington.ma.us>, Doug Heim <dheim@town.arlington.ma.us>, Adam Chapdelaine <AChapdelaine@town.arlington.ma.us>
Subject: Unofficial Arlington Town Meeting Slack

Hi everybody, I'm writing to let you know, if you haven't already heard, that I run an unofficial "Slack" group for Arlington Town Meeting Members.

Any TMM who hasn't joined yet and wishes to do so may use this invitation link. Please do not share it with non-TMMs:

https://join.slack.com/t/townmeeting/shared_invite/zt-19pb8nmf8-HYnCl08ReRPbYVRaQWOL4A

My vision for the Slack has been pretty simple from day one, to effectively fill in for the missed opportunity to whisper to our neighbors, and chat with the general assembly during breaks, like we do when Town Meeting is held at Town Hall.

The Slack has been an enormous success so far, exceeding my expectations and, I think, the expectations of many others.

From the beginning the Slack has been open to every ACTIVE Town Meeting Member, but I have recently come to realize that not everybody "got the memo" so to speak. I expected that word of mouth following the initial creation and sharing key members from many precincts would have gotten the word spread far and wide.

Some of you may have heard rumors that the Slack is exclusionary or biased toward one point of view or another. I, along with a group of other TMMs I have recruited from the Slack, have worked to discourage exclusionary behavior and personal attacks. People

who are in the Slack are expected to express their opinions about the various issues before Town Meeting cordially and with respect for other members. Essentially: the same behavior that would be expected in the confines of Town Hall.

The level of civility in the Slack has been overall very good, and we do our best to remind others, and sometimes ourselves, to maintain that civility. Even when emotions start to run high, casting aspersions or attacking people personally, is not accepted behavior in the Slack.

I hope that if you haven't heard about the Slack yet, or if you heard about it early on but didn't think it sounded compelling, that you will consider joining us in earnest. I expect, based on the success of the group so far, that it will remain a valuable resource for Town Meeting as long as we continue to meet virtually, and perhaps even afterwards.

We have had really good luck so far with only Town Meeting Members using the invitation links, with the exception of one person who I had to remove from the Slack. It's important to me, and I think to many other Town Meeting Members, that the scope of the Slack be limited to the same group of people who would ordinarily be able to converse in Town Hall at Town Meeting.

If anybody has any questions or concerns, I'm happy to hear them. Please email me privately, or if you are already in the Slack, feel free to send me a direct message there.

Cordially,

Daniel Jalkut
Town Meeting Member, Precinct 6
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